

TCS NQT Verbal Ability — 100 Practice Questions + Passage Summary + Email Writing

A quick note on the current pattern

Prep sources currently disagree slightly on the exact 2026 format, so prepare for both versions:

- **Classic pattern** (still widely reported): ~24-25 questions in ~25-30 minutes — synonyms, antonyms, sentence completion, error spotting, reading comprehension, and para-jumbles (sentence rearrangement). No negative marking.
- **Newer "communication-focused" pattern** (reported by some 2026 prep portals): 20 Sentence Completion questions + 4 **Passage Recall** tasks (read a short passage for ~30 seconds, then rewrite it from memory in your own words within ~90 seconds) + 1 **Professional Email Writing** question (a formal email of ~100 words in ~9 minutes).

Since both patterns keep showing up in recent candidate reports, this sheet covers **all three pieces** — the 100 MCQ-style questions, passage-to-summary practice, and email writing — so you're covered either way.

PART 1 — 100 Verbal MCQs

Section 1: Synonyms (Q1-15)

1. **Ephemeral** — A) Everlasting B) Short-lived C) Beautiful D) Ancient
2. **Candid** — A) Deceptive B) Frank C) Silent D) Angry
3. **Meticulous** — A) Careless B) Thorough C) Fast D) Lazy
4. **Ambiguous** — A) Clear B) Unclear C) Simple D) Direct
5. **Benevolent** — A) Cruel B) Kind C) Greedy D) Selfish
6. **Pragmatic** — A) Idealistic B) Practical C) Emotional D) Theoretical
7. **Novice** — A) Expert B) Beginner C) Veteran D) Teacher
8. **Tranquil** — A) Chaotic B) Calm C) Loud D) Busy
9. **Elated** — A) Sad B) Overjoyed C) Angry D) Tired
10. **Diligent** — A) Lazy B) Hardworking C) Careless D) Slow
11. **Prudent** — A) Reckless B) Cautious/wise C) Foolish D) Impulsive
12. **Concise** — A) Lengthy B) Brief C) Vague D) Confusing
13. **Adverse** — A) Favorable B) Unfavorable C) Neutral D) Strong
14. **Robust** — A) Weak B) Strong C) Fragile D) Slow
15. **Verify** — A) Doubt B) Confirm C) Ignore D) Deny

Section 2: Antonyms (Q16-30)

16. **Abundant** — A) Scarce B) Plentiful C) Rich D) Huge
17. **Frugal** — A) Wasteful B) Thrifty C) Careful D) Stingy
18. **Optimistic** — A) Hopeful B) Pessimistic C) Cheerful D) Positive
19. **Genuine** — A) Real B) Fake C) Honest D) Authentic
20. **Reluctant** — A) Hesitant B) Willing C) Unwilling D) Shy
21. **Transparent** — A) Clear B) Obvious C) Opaque D) Visible
22. **Amateur** — A) Beginner B) Professional C) Novice D) Learner
23. **Expand** — A) Grow B) Contract C) Increase D) Enlarge
24. **Humble** — A) Modest B) Arrogant C) Shy D) Quiet
25. **Permanent** — A) Lasting B) Temporary C) Fixed D) Stable
26. **Vague** — A) Unclear B) Precise C) Ambiguous D) Fuzzy
27. **Include** — A) Add B) Exclude C) Contain D) Involve
28. **Ancient** — A) Old B) Modern C) Antique D) Historic
29. **Generous** — A) Kind B) Stingy C) Giving D) Charitable
30. **Victory** — A) Win B) Defeat C) Success D) Triumph

Section 3: Sentence Completion (Q31-50)

31. Despite the heavy rain, the team decided to ___ the outdoor event as scheduled. A) cancel B) proceed with C) forget D) postpone indefinitely
32. The manager was ___ impressed by the intern's ___ approach to solving the client's issue. A) hardly / careless B) genuinely / innovative C) rarely / typical D) never / dull
33. Employees who arrive late without prior notice will face ___ action. A) disciplinary B) rewarding C) casual D) optional
34. The new policy aims to ___ transparency ___ all departments. A) reduce / within B) increase / across C) limit / beyond D) avoid / among
35. Although the report was ___, it lacked ___ data to support its conclusions. A) short / sufficient B) detailed / unnecessary C) long / extra D) brief / redundant
36. She was ___ to learn that her project had been ___ for the annual award. A) thrilled / shortlisted B) upset / rejected fully C) indifferent / ignored D) confused / cancelled
37. The company plans to ___ its operations to three new cities next year. A) shrink B) expand C) delay D) abandon
38. It is ___ that all candidates submit their documents before the ___. A) mandatory / deadline B) optional / beginning C) unnecessary / interview D) suggested / party
39. The client was ___ with the delay and demanded an ___ explanation. A) satisfied / vague B) annoyed / immediate C) pleased / late D) calm / eventual

40. Due to budget constraints, the firm had to ___ several projects this quarter. A) launch
B) postpone C) celebrate D) fund fully
41. The professor's lecture was so ___ that students struggled to stay ___. A) engaging /
awake B) monotonous / awake C) short / asleep D) clear / confused
42. The startup's rapid growth can be attributed to its ___ marketing strategy. A) outdated
B) innovative C) careless D) confusing
43. He remained ___ under pressure, which impressed the entire panel. A) anxious B)
composed C) frantic D) irritated
44. The committee will ___ the proposal before making a final decision. A) ignore B)
review C) discard D) forget
45. Her argument was ___, leaving no room for ___. A) weak / agreement B) convincing /
doubt C) confusing / clarity D) short / debate
46. The organization is committed to ___ sustainable practices across all its offices. A)
avoiding B) implementing C) rejecting D) postponing
47. Despite facing several setbacks, the team remained ___ about the project's success. A)
pessimistic B) optimistic C) indifferent D) doubtful
48. The new software update ___ several bugs that had frustrated users for months. A)
created B) fixed C) ignored D) worsened
49. The negotiations were ___ and took much longer than either party expected. A) swift
B) prolonged C) brief D) simple
50. Given the ___ feedback, the team decided to revise the entire proposal. A) positive B)
critical C) minor D) irrelevant

Section 4: Error Spotting (Q51-70)

Each sentence is split into four parts (A/B/C/D). Identify which part contains the grammatical error.

51. The committee (A) / have decided (B) / to postpone (C) / the meeting until next week (D).
52. Neither of the employees (A) / were informed (B) / about the change (C) / in the schedule (D).
53. She along with her colleagues (A) / are attending (B) / the conference (C) / next Monday (D).
54. Each of the students (A) / have submitted (B) / their assignments (C) / before the deadline (D).
55. The number of applicants (A) / have increased (B) / significantly (C) / this year (D).
56. He is one of the few managers (A) / who is capable (B) / of handling such (C) / a difficult situation (D).

57. By the time the manager arrives (A) / we will finished (B) / the entire report (C) / for review (D).
58. I have been working in this company (A) / since (B) / five years (C) / now (D).
59. If I would have known (A) / about the delay (B) / I would have left (C) / earlier (D).
60. She is married with (A) / a software engineer (B) / who works (C) / in Bangalore (D).
61. He is good in (A) / mathematics (B) / but weak (C) / in science (D).
62. The manager insisted that he (A) / completes the report (B) / before leaving (C) / for the day (D).
63. One of the biggest challenge (A) / facing the company (B) / is retaining skilled (C) / employees (D).
64. The data shows (A) / that most employees (B) / prefers remote work (C) / over office work (D).
65. Scarcely had the meeting begun (A) / when the fire alarm (B) / rang and everyone (C) / evacuate the building (D).
66. The report, along with the annexures (A) / were submitted (B) / to the board (C) / yesterday (D).
67. He divided the money between (A) / the three partners (B) / equally (C) / last week (D).
68. Neither the manager nor the employees (A) / was aware (B) / of the new policy (C) / until yesterday (D).
69. The company have (A) / announced (B) / a new policy (C) / for all employees (D).
70. I have completed the assignment (A) / yesterday (B) / and submitted it (C) / on time (D).

Section 5: Sentence Rearrangement / Para Jumbles (Q71-85)

Arrange sentences P, Q, R, S into the most logical order.

71. P: This makes them ideal for remote monitoring in agriculture. Q: Sensors can now transmit data wirelessly over long distances. R: As a result, farmers can track soil conditions without visiting the field. S: Advances in battery technology have made these devices last much longer.
72. P: The company had grown rapidly over the past decade. Q: However, this expansion came at the cost of employee morale. R: Many workers reported feeling overworked and undervalued. S: To address this, management introduced a flexible leave policy.
73. P: Cloud computing allows businesses to store data remotely. Q: This reduces the need for expensive physical infrastructure. R: Small businesses, in particular, benefit from lower upfront costs. S: As a result, more startups are adopting cloud-based solutions.
74. P: The museum's new exhibit focuses on ancient trade routes. Q: Visitors can see maps, coins, and artifacts from various civilizations. R: It opened last month to positive

reviews. S: The exhibit highlights how trade shaped cultural exchange.

75. P: Remote work became widespread after 2020. Q: Many companies initially viewed it as a temporary measure. R: Over time, however, they recognized its long-term benefits. S: Today, hybrid work models are the norm in many industries.
76. P: The report highlighted a decline in customer satisfaction. Q: It recommended immediate changes to the support process. R: Management reviewed the findings carefully. S: Within weeks, a new support system was implemented.
77. P: Solar panel costs have fallen sharply in the last decade. Q: This price drop has made solar energy accessible to more households. R: Government subsidies have further encouraged adoption. S: As a result, rooftop solar installations have surged across the country.
78. P: The library introduced a new digital catalog system. Q: Students can now search for books using keywords online. R: This has significantly reduced the time spent searching shelves. S: The system was launched at the start of this semester.
79. P: The city council approved a new recycling initiative. Q: Residents will receive separate bins for organic and plastic waste. R: The initiative aims to cut landfill waste by 30 percent. S: It will be rolled out in phases starting next month.
80. P: Artificial intelligence is transforming customer service. Q: Chatbots can now handle routine queries instantly. R: This frees up human agents for complex issues. S: Companies report higher customer satisfaction as a result.
81. P: The bridge had been closed for repairs for six months. Q: Engineers discovered structural cracks during a routine inspection. R: It finally reopened to traffic last week. S: The repair work cost more than initially estimated.
82. P: The startup launched its mobile app last year. Q: Within months, it gained over a million downloads. R: Investors took notice of this rapid growth. S: The company recently secured a new round of funding.
83. P: Air pollution levels in the city have risen sharply. Q: Health officials have issued advisories urging residents to stay indoors. R: Traffic congestion is considered a major contributing factor. S: The city plans to introduce stricter emission norms next year.
84. P: The company rolled out a new training program for employees. Q: It focuses on developing leadership and communication skills. R: Early feedback from participants has been overwhelmingly positive. S: The program will be expanded to all departments next quarter.
85. P: The novel was originally rejected by several publishers. Q: One small press finally agreed to print a limited run. R: Word of mouth helped it gain a wider readership. S: It eventually became a bestseller within a year.

Section 6: Reading Comprehension (Q86-100)

Passage 1 (Q86-90): Over the last decade, small and medium-sized businesses across India have increasingly turned to cloud-based software to manage their daily operations. Instead

of investing heavily in physical servers and in-house IT staff, these companies now rent computing power and storage from large technology providers, paying only for what they use. This shift has lowered the barrier to entry for new businesses, allowing a small retailer or a local logistics firm to access tools once reserved for large corporations. Cloud adoption has also enabled better collaboration, since teams working from different cities can access the same files and applications in real time. However, this convenience comes with new risks. A single service outage at a cloud provider can disrupt operations for thousands of businesses simultaneously, and data stored remotely raises fresh questions about privacy and security. Despite these concerns, most industry analysts expect the trend toward cloud adoption to continue, driven largely by cost savings and the flexibility it offers to growing companies.

86. What is the main advantage of cloud computing mentioned for small businesses? A) Better marketing B) Lower cost of entry, since heavy IT infrastructure isn't needed C) Guaranteed data security D) Higher profits
87. According to the passage, what is a risk associated with cloud computing? A) Increased hiring cost B) Service outages affecting many businesses at once C) Reduced collaboration D) Higher server costs
88. The word "adoption" in the passage most nearly means: A) Rejection B) Uptake / acceptance C) Invention D) Regulation
89. Why can teams in different cities collaborate better using cloud tools? A) They can access the same files/applications in real time B) They no longer need internet C) They use physical servers together D) They hire more staff
90. What do most industry analysts expect regarding cloud adoption? A) It will decline B) It will continue growing due to cost and flexibility C) It will be banned D) It will only be used by large companies

Passage 2 (Q91-95): Wind energy has become one of the fastest-growing sources of electricity worldwide, driven by falling turbine costs and supportive government policies. Coastal regions with strong, steady winds have proven especially attractive for large-scale wind farms, since offshore turbines can be built taller and capture more consistent wind speeds than their onshore counterparts. Critics, however, point to the visual impact of turbines on coastal landscapes and their potential effect on migratory bird populations. Engineers are now developing turbine designs intended to reduce noise and minimize harm to wildlife, while researchers study optimal farm layouts that limit ecological disruption. Meanwhile, several governments have introduced tax incentives to encourage private investment in wind infrastructure, hoping to reduce dependence on fossil fuels. Industry experts note that while wind energy alone cannot meet all future electricity demand, it is expected to remain a key part of a broader mix of renewable sources, alongside solar and hydropower, as countries work toward reducing carbon emissions over the coming decades.

91. Why are offshore wind turbines considered more effective than onshore ones? A) They are cheaper to build B) They capture more consistent, stronger winds C) They require less maintenance D) They are quieter
92. What concern do critics raise about wind farms? A) High electricity prices B) Effect on bird populations and landscape impact C) Limited job creation D) Overuse of land
93. What are governments doing to encourage wind energy investment? A) Banning fossil fuels immediately B) Offering tax incentives C) Reducing turbine production D) Increasing electricity prices
94. The phrase "ecological disruption" refers to: A) Economic loss B) Harm to the natural environment/wildlife C) Political conflict D) Technical failure
95. According to the passage, what role will wind energy play in the future? A) It will completely replace fossil fuels alone B) It will be one part of a broader renewable energy mix C) It will be phased out D) It will only be used offshore

Passage 3 (Q96–100): A growing number of organizations are rethinking how they evaluate employee performance, moving away from the traditional annual review toward more frequent, informal check-ins. Proponents argue that yearly reviews often rely on managers' memory of events from months earlier, making feedback less accurate and less useful. Regular check-ins, by contrast, allow managers to address concerns while they are still relevant and to recognize achievements soon after they happen. Some companies have gone further, replacing numerical performance ratings altogether with open conversations focused on growth and development. Critics of this approach warn that removing formal ratings can make it harder to justify decisions about promotions or compensation, since there is less documented evidence to rely on. Human resources professionals suggest that the most effective systems combine the best of both approaches: frequent informal feedback throughout the year, paired with a lighter, well-documented formal review at year's end.

96. Why do proponents prefer frequent check-ins over annual reviews? A) They are cheaper B) Annual reviews rely on memory and can be less accurate C) They take less time overall D) They eliminate the need for managers
97. What is one criticism of removing formal performance ratings? A) It makes reviews too long B) It can make promotion/compensation decisions harder to justify C) It increases costs D) It reduces employee morale
98. What do HR professionals suggest as the most effective system? A) Only annual reviews B) A combination of frequent informal feedback and a documented year-end review C) No reviews at all D) Only numerical ratings
99. The word "proponents" in the passage most nearly means: A) Opponents B) Supporters C) Critics D) Employees
100. What is the overall theme of the passage? A) The history of workplace technology B) Changing approaches to employee performance evaluation C) How to calculate

Answer Key (Part 1)

Synonyms (1–15): 1-B, 2-B, 3-B, 4-B, 5-B, 6-B, 7-B, 8-B, 9-B, 10-B, 11-B, 12-B, 13-B, 14-B, 15-B

Antonyms (16–30): 16-A, 17-A, 18-B, 19-B, 20-B, 21-C, 22-B, 23-B, 24-B, 25-B, 26-B, 27-B, 28-

B, 29-B, 30-B **Sentence Completion (31–50):** 31-B, 32-B, 33-A, 34-B, 35-A, 36-A, 37-B, 38-A,

39-B, 40-B, 41-B, 42-B, 43-B, 44-B, 45-B, 46-B, 47-B, 48-B, 49-B, 50-B **Error Spotting (51–**

70) — part containing the error: 51-B (have→has) · 52-B (were→was) · 53-B (are→is) · 54-B

(have→has) · 55-B (have→has) · 56-B (is→are) · 57-B (will finished→will have finished) · 58-C

("since"→"for five years") · 59-A (would have known→had known) · 60-A (married

with→married to) · 61-A (good in→good at) · 62-B (completes→complete) · 63-A

(challenge→challenges) · 64-C (prefers→prefer) · 65-D (evacuate→evacuated) · 66-B

(were→was) · 67-A (between→among) · 68-B (was→were) · 69-A (have→has) · 70-A (have

completed→completed) **Para Jumbles (71–85)** — correct order: 71: Q-S-P-R · 72: P-Q-R-S ·

73: P-Q-R-S · 74: P-R-Q-S · 75: P-Q-R-S · 76: P-R-Q-S · 77: P-Q-R-S · 78: P-S-Q-R · 79: P-R-Q-S ·

80: P-Q-R-S · 81: Q-P-S-R · 82: P-Q-R-S · 83: P-R-Q-S · 84: P-Q-R-S · 85: P-Q-R-S **Reading**

Comprehension (86–100): 86-B, 87-B, 88-B, 89-A, 90-B, 91-B, 92-B, 93-B, 94-B, 95-B, 96-B,

97-B, 98-B, 99-B, 100-B

PART 2 — Sentence-to-Summary (Passage Recall) Practice

This is the newer format: you read a short passage (roughly 100–150 words) for about **30 seconds**, then the passage disappears and you must write a summary of it **in your own words** within about **90 seconds**. It tests memory + paraphrasing, not copying — so practice condensing, not memorizing word-for-word.

Practice Passage 1: A mid-sized manufacturing firm recently began a trial of a four-day workweek, keeping salaries unchanged while reducing total working hours. Early results showed no drop in output, and employee surveys reported lower stress and higher job satisfaction. Managers noted that meetings became shorter and more focused, since teams had less time to spare during the week. The company plans to extend the trial for another six months before deciding whether to make the policy permanent across all departments.

Model summary: A manufacturing firm trialed a four-day workweek at full pay, and output stayed steady while employee stress dropped and meetings grew more efficient. The company will extend the trial six more months before deciding on a permanent rollout.

Practice Passage 2: The city's public transport authority unveiled a plan to replace its aging bus fleet with electric buses over the next five years. Officials said the switch would cut air pollution significantly in congested areas and reduce long-term fuel costs, despite the higher upfront price of electric vehicles. The first batch of 50 electric buses will begin operating on high-traffic routes early next year, with charging stations being built at three major depots.

Model summary: The city plans to replace its old buses with electric ones over five years to cut pollution and long-term fuel costs. Fifty electric buses will start running on busy routes next year, supported by new charging stations at three depots.

Practice Passage 3: Researchers recently discovered a new method of purifying water using a low-cost filter made from agricultural waste, such as rice husks. In lab tests, the filter removed over 90 percent of common contaminants at a fraction of the cost of existing filtration technologies. The team believes this could be especially useful in rural areas lacking access to clean drinking water, and they are now seeking partners to test the filter in real-world conditions.

Model summary: Researchers developed a cheap water filter from agricultural waste like rice husks that removed over 90% of contaminants in lab tests. They hope it can help rural areas without clean water access and are now looking for partners for real-world trials.

Practice Passage 4: A recent workplace study found that employees who took short breaks every 90 minutes were significantly more productive than those who worked through the day without pausing. The study tracked over 500 office workers across multiple industries and found that structured breaks also reduced reported fatigue by the end of the workday. Researchers recommend that companies build brief break reminders into employee schedules rather than relying on individual discipline alone.

Model summary: A study of 500+ office workers found that taking short breaks every 90 minutes boosted productivity and reduced end-of-day fatigue compared to working without pauses. Researchers suggest companies build break reminders into schedules instead of leaving it to individual willpower.

Practice Passage 5: A logistics company announced a new sustainability initiative aimed at cutting its carbon emissions by 40 percent within five years. The plan includes switching part of its delivery fleet to electric vehicles, optimizing delivery routes using software to reduce unnecessary mileage, and partnering with local warehouses to shorten last-mile delivery distances. The company said the initiative was driven both by client demand for greener logistics and by long-term cost savings on fuel.

Model summary: A logistics company launched a plan to cut carbon emissions 40% in five years by adding electric vehicles, optimizing delivery routes, and shortening last-mile distances through local warehouse partnerships. The move responds to client demand for greener logistics and expected fuel savings.

How to practice this at home: set a 30-second timer, read one passage, cover it, then give yourself 90 seconds to write a 2-3 sentence summary from memory. Compare against the model summary — check whether you kept the key facts (who/what/numbers) rather than exact wording.

PART 3 — Email Writing Topics

Format basics reported across recent cycles: a **formal email**, typically ~**80–100 words**, within a **9–10 minute** window. You're usually given a scenario plus a signing name — pay close attention to who you're writing to and who you're signing as, since missing these details costs easy marks.

Practice topics (based on commonly reported real scenarios):

1. Write to your manager requesting **casual/sick leave** for 2–3 days due to a family emergency.
2. Write to HR requesting to **work from home** for a week due to a medical reason.
3. Write to a client apologizing for a **delayed delivery** and explaining the revised timeline.
4. Write to your team requesting a **meeting reschedule** due to a scheduling conflict.
5. Write to the manager of a company **complaining about poor after-sales service** on a recent purchase.
6. Write to your college principal, as a student representative, **inviting another institution** to a technical symposium.
7. Write to a professor/colleague **inviting them to a farewell/retirement event**.
8. Write to your office administration **reporting a facility issue** (e.g., broken AC, unsafe wiring) that needs urgent attention.
9. Write to a customer **informing them of a change in office address** and updated contact details.
10. Write to your manager **requesting approval** for a training course or certification relevant to your role.
11. Write to a vendor **negotiating a payment extension** due to temporary cash-flow issues.
12. Write to a customer **reminding them of an overdue payment**, politely but firmly.
13. Write to your team **announcing a policy change** (e.g., updated attendance rules).
14. Write to a municipal officer **reporting a nuisance** (e.g., a noisy or unsafe construction site nearby).
15. Write to your manager **summarizing project progress** and flagging a risk that needs their attention.
16. Write to HR **raising a workplace grievance** professionally (e.g., about a scheduling conflict or unclear policy).
17. Write to a colleague **thanking them** for help on a project and acknowledging their contribution.
18. Write to a supplier **placing a purchase order** with specific quantities and delivery deadlines.

19. Write to your manager **requesting a shift change** due to a personal commitment.
20. Write to a training coordinator **confirming attendance** at an upcoming workshop and asking a logistics question.

Quick format template:

Subject: [Clear, specific – e.g. "Leave Request: 3 Days – Family Emergency"]

Dear [Name/Designation],

[Paragraph 1: State the purpose clearly in the first line.]

[Paragraph 2: Give necessary details – dates, numbers, context.]

[Paragraph 3: State what you need from the reader, or what happens next.]

Regards,

[Your name as instructed in the question]

Sample answer (Topic 1 — leave request):

Subject: Leave Request: 2 Days – Family Emergency

Dear Mr. Sharma,

I am writing to request leave for two days, from Monday to Tuesday this week, due to a sudden family emergency that requires my presence at home.

I have briefed my colleague, Ananya, on my current tasks, and she will be reachable for any urgent client queries during my absence. I will also remain available over email for anything critical.

I would be grateful for your approval and apologize for the short notice.

Regards, Rohan

Sample answer (Topic 5 — complaint email):

Subject: Complaint: Poor Service Support – AC Unit (Order #4521)

Dear Mr. Naryana,

I am writing to raise a concern about the after-sales service for the air conditioner I purchased from your store last month. Despite two scheduled visits, the technician did not resolve the cooling issue, and I have not received any follow-up since.

I would appreciate it if you could arrange a proper inspection at the earliest and keep me informed of the next steps.

Regards, Parnika

Tips that consistently matter:

- Get the **subject line specific**, not generic ("Leave Request" beats just "Request").

- Match the **tone** to the scenario — apologetic for complaints, firm-but-polite for overdue payments, warm for invitations.
- Always **sign as instructed** in the question — a perfect email signed with the wrong name still loses marks.
- Keep it within the word range — too short looks incomplete, too long wastes your limited time.